for these institutions, regard should be had to geographical distribution along with efficiency.

Sir Shanmukham Chetty emphasized that the balanced character and composition of international trade was as important to the underdeveloped nations as an increase in the volume of exports and imports. He pointed out that exports of raw material and foodstuffs from the underdeveloped countries and import of manufactured goods from the advanced nations did not constitute balanced international trade. It was only by greater attention to the industrial needs of developing countries like India that a real and rational balance could be achieved. For this reason, the Indian delegation wanted specific mention of 'the needs of economically backward countries, in the description of objectives of economic policy, which the Fund cannot directly assist but may indirectly facilitate'.[18] This, however, encountered similar criticisms, and eventually Article I (ii) of the Fund was 'to facilitate the expansion and balanced growth of international trade, and to contribute thereby to the promotion and maintenance of high levels of employment and real income and to the development of the productive resources of all members as primary objectives of economic policy'.[19] As Deshmukh observed in a speech in Bombay a few months later: 'Our case rested on the proposition that poverty and plenty are infectious and that if the operation of an international body like that projected was not to grow lopsided, it was necessary to pay special attention to the development of countries like India with resources awaiting development. Our appeal was to enlightened self-interest.'[20]

Anand Chandavarkar notes that Keynes did not take any position on these proposals of the Indian delegation although he was in close contact with them. Deshmukh was present, along with Sir Jeremy Raisman and Sir Theodore Gregory, at the second informal meeting with Dominion and Indian representatives which was held in Keynes's room at Atlantic City on June 25. This meeting was convened to enable Keynes to report on his discussions with White, which, however, did not cover the broad objectives of the Fund. Keynes's silence on this proposal of the Indian delegation was an implicit acknowledgement that he too believed that the developmental role belonged to the proposed Bank.[21] Deshmukh observes in his memoirs how he met Lionel Robbins (later Lord) and Prof. Dennis Robertson at Atlantic City.[22] He could not see much of Keynes because of the latter's ill-